

EVERYDAY MILLIONAIRE

David, a millionaire from Oklahoma, was born to parents who taught him the basics of money management from an early age. His father was an engineer, and his mother was a schoolteacher. Together, his parents made enough to meet the needs of the family, but David remembers them as frugal. They taught him how to save money and the importance of staying away from debt—two lessons that shaped his financial future. After high school, David went on to pursue a bachelor's degree in civil engineering and a PhD in aerospace engineering. He settled into a long, thirty-five-year career as a college professor and, in his spare time, started two different software companies. All these things were in pursuit of a goal he'd had most of his life: to become financially independent.

David learned early in his working life that there is a big difference between wealth and income. He figured out that his income could either come from a *job* or from his *wealth*, and he set his sights on a wealth-based income stream, picturing a day when his investments would support the life he and his wife dreamed of. To make that dream a reality, they maximized their 401(k), 403(b), and IRAs. They carefully considered other opportunities as they came along, always weighing the risk against the long-term goal they were chasing. They also used an investment professional to help make the best investing decisions throughout their working lifetime.